the service mesh. These policies go beyond what is supported by network policies and can control access based on HTTP methods and paths. For example, you can allow one service to only make GET requests to another service. See https://istio.io/docs/concepts/security/#authorization for more details. If you have a dedicated security team, then service-mesh authorization allows them to enforce consistent security controls across the cluster, allowing API development teams to concentrate on their unique security requirements.

> WARNING Although service-mesh authorization policies can significantly harden your network, they are not a replacement for API authorization mechanisms. For example, service-mesh authorization provides little protection against the SSRF attacks discussed in section 10.2.7 because the malicious requests will be transparently authenticated by the proxies just like legitimate requests.

10.4 Securing incoming requests

So far, you've only secured communications between microservice APIs within the cluster. The Natter API can also be called by clients outside the cluster, which you've been doing with curl. To secure requests into the cluster you can enable an *ingress controller* that will receive all requests arriving from external sources as shown in figure 10.7. An ingress controller is a reverse proxy or load balancer, and can be configured to perform TLS termination, rate-limiting, audit logging, and other basic security controls. Requests